

Excel Reading with Apache POI

Quick Revision Notes • Maven Dependency • Workbook → Sheet → Row → Cell

1. Excel Structure — Remember This First



2. Steps to Read an Excel File

Step	What to do	Key code / concept
1	Add Maven dependency	Apache POI → poi-ooxml
2	Provide Excel file path	String filepath = ...
3	Open the file	FileInputStream fis = new FileInputStream(filepath);
4	Create workbook & access sheet	XSSFWorkbook → XSSFSheet
5	Read rows and cells	getRow(index) → getCell(index)
6	Loop through data	for row → for column

3. Maven Dependency

```
<dependency>
  <groupId>org.apache.poi</groupId>
  <artifactId>poi-ooxml</artifactId>
  <version>5.4.1</version>
</dependency>
```

4. Basic Java Flow

```
String filepath = System.getProperty("user.dir") + "\\TestData\\TestData.xlsx";

FileInputStream fis = new FileInputStream(filepath);
XSSFWorkbook workbook = new XSSFWorkbook(fis);
XSSFSheet sheet = workbook.getSheet("Sheet1");

int rows = sheet.getLastRowNum();
int columns = sheet.getRow(0).getLastCellNum();
```

5. Row & Column Indexing

Item	Indexing / Return Value	Example
Row index	Starts from 0	First row = 0, last data row = 5
Column index	Starts from 0	A = 0, B = 1, C = 2, D = 3
getLastRowNum()	Returns the LAST ROW INDEX	6 rows → returns 5
getLastCellNum()	Returns the number of cells	4 columns → returns 4

Interview Memory Trick

getLastRowNum() → **LAST INDEX**

getLastCellNum() → **COUNT**

6. Example Excel — How the Indexes Work

Row \ Column	0	1	2	3
0	BookName	PurchasedDate	Amount	Location
1	selenium	29-Jul-2019	350	Africa
2	Java	29-Jul-2019	200	Africa
3	Python	29-Jul-2019	250	Asia
4	Jmeter	29-Jul-2019	150	Asia
5	C#	29-Jul-2019	300	Asia

7. Loop Pattern

```
for (int r = 0; r <= sheet.getLastRowNum(); r++) {  
    for (int c = 0; c < sheet.getRow(r).getLastCellNum(); c++) {  
        String data = sheet.getRow(r).getCell(c).toString();  
        System.out.println(data);  
    }  
}
```

Final 10-second revision: Workbook → Sheet → Row → Cell | Row/Column indexes start at 0 |
getLastRowNum() = last row index | getLastCellNum() = column count